Jacky Alciné

I'm a self-taught software engineer that learns in the open and aims to use or work with open tooling and software. For 12 years, I've worked on a wide range of projects — from billing management, user message multiplexing services and custom user application deployment.

Technologies

These are things I'm familiar (roughly sorted by "expertise"):

Ruby • Python • TypeScript & JavaScript • Rust • HTML • CSS • Flask • Clojure • PHP • ExpressJS

Interests

These are things I'd like to incorporate (but aren't required) in my next role:

Hypercore • SQLite • IndieWeb • ZeroMQ • Pulumi • ActivityPub •

Hashicorp's suite of tools (Terraform, Packer, Nomad) • Wordpress

Roles

Plural Policy

Senior Fullstack Web Engineer from Feb 2024 to May 2024

I worked on different parts of the Plural platform, mainly around continuing an effot on revamping the experience of handling and viewing legislative information. I worked with other team members in code review efforts &mdash it being a nimble and small team. This included working on a Nest.js server and React frontend deployed on GCP.

After discussion on the eventual growth of both the organizaiton and my role there, Plural and I parted ways on 31 May 2024.

Code for America

Senior Software Engineer from Nov 2022 to Sept 2023

I joined the **Tax Benefits** team in order to help the effort of maintaining one of the flagship

projects, Get Your Refund, an open-source Rails application meant to provide VITA volunteers and sites a means of helping people file for tax benefits.

- Spent lots of time pairing on features to distribute team's understanding
- Wrote out documents around changes to the platform to help commodify understanding
- Spent time working on changes to help reduce noise of the maintaining of vita-min

I was impacted by layoffs Code for America ran in 2023.

Eden Health

Senior Software Engineer from Jan 2022 to Aug 2022

After learning Clojure on the job, my main role was working on feature development on the core monolith of Eden Health, written in the same. While database work was done using SQLAlchemy, I dipped back and forth between codebases to make changes whenever necessary (and assisting teammates throughout the way). Some of these changes included expanding what registration options patients had in terms of linking insurances and other important quality of life improvements.

I was impacted by layoffs to engineering at Eden Health in 2022.

Nava PBC

Software Engineer from Dec 2020 to June 2021

While at Nava, I worked mainly on helping the effort of delivering payments to those claiming benefits for those qualified by the Commonthwealth of Massachusetts (family leave and unemployment insurance, for example). Some of the work I got to focus on was developing the pipeline for said requests and helping insure integrity of the transactions over time. The logic for this work was done mainly using Python and AWS services.

Due to a personal crisis, I couldn't continue working at Nava PBC and we parted ways.

Glitch

Software Engineer from Aug 2019 to May 2020

During my time on the Platform team at Glitch, I contributed to:

- Refactoring endpoints in the existing API system to a newer one
- Adding tooling to make internal project statements easier
- Updating internal clients to make use of the newer API

The stack being completely in TypeScript made it easy for teams to contribute, including myself when it came to working on the frontend.

I was impacted by layoffs at Glitch in 2020.

Lob

Senior Software Engineer from Nov 2017 to July 2018

I was responsible for improving PDF rendering for clients of their final letters and adding functionality for customers to dynamically add and remove features from their accounts. After working on that, I made vital improvements to how the internal implementations of the payment software worked to allow for a simpler form of usage-based billing.

I left Lob to start a consulting career.

Lyft

Software Engineer from Jan 2017 to September 2017

Some of the things I worked on at Lyft were:

- Working on implementing a message templating system to replace explicit calls to vendors to reach users
- Added an interface in the internal system to manipulate said templates and make them visible in user profiles
- Added adaptivity to said tooling to allow for users to adjust their channels for receiving information
- Added logic to help use less numbers when routing calls between users

Clef

Software Engineer from November 2015 to September 2016

During my time at Clef, I

- Maintained and added new functionality the Android library (SDK)
- Maintained the Cordova cross-platform SDK for mobile developers
- Worked on the core API used by our client applications by improving response times to inbound requests
- Moved our development environment to use more virtualization.
- Worked on the cross-platform mobile SDK for Instant 2FA

Shutterstock

Software Engineer from Apr 2014 to Dec 2014

Joining the Contributor team, I assisted in the partitioning of legacy software that made up the Contributor site as well as the implementation of the new Contributor Guides site. I ended up writing out the basis of a functional acceptance test suite for the majority of the Contributor site. Lots of pair programming practices were used here and were heavily encouraged as well keeping the contracts upheld by tests as accurate as possible. Rebuilding the static nature of the Contributor site involved using a cached CMS powered view that allowed product to update the pages without requiring a complete new deploy of the website.

Consulting

I've worked with a range of clients on different kinds of software needs, stacks, languages and with different responbilities. My ability to jump in and get going is one that's kept me going and interesting in consulting. I begun my career consutling and always found it to be a good and exhilarating way to help people build the things they're envisioning and fix the problems that's been ailing them.

Companies I've consulted include the Electronic Frontier Foundation, Color of Change, Paddle8, Whose Your Landlord, BLS, Viridis Learning, Bareburger and Horizon Media.

My preferred working conditions for proposals and contracts:

- Include my daily rate of **USD $500** or hourly rate of **$60**. I optimize for hourly for short term (less than two months) role and daily for longer term contracts.
- A maximum of **four days worked per week** (for work-life balance).

The conditions above can be flexible provided good reason, market stability and personal welfare. **Please reach out** if you'd like me to work with you (or your organization).